

# obsidian-mcp-router — quick reference

v0.48.0 · multi-vault Obsidian MCP server + Claude Code plugin (45 slash commands · 42 MCP tools · 42 skills)

[github.com/tboome33/obsidian-mcp-router](https://github.com/tboome33/obsidian-mcp-router)

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## The router in 30 seconds

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A single MCP process that knows **all your Obsidian vaults** (local + remote). Each tool takes a `vault` parameter (or uses the default). No more registering one MCP server per vault.

- **One entry** in `~/.claude.json` → all vaults visible everywhere (Code + Desktop)
- **Local + remote vaults** treated identically — drop URL + API key into the config, done
- **Cross-vault:** `vault: "*"`  auto-fans-out across every vault
- **Lock mode:** restrict the session to a single vault (safety, focus) · **Auto-enrichment:** Claude suggests wiki saves at 3 natural moments, 4 modes ( `ClaudeAsk` / `Hybrid` / `FullAuto` / `off` )
- **Conversion toolbox** (v0.11+): PDF / DOCX / XLSX / PPTX / image (OCR) / audio / YouTube / webpage / git repo → markdown; opt-in **Docling** high-fidelity PDF + `pdf_to_images` (the model sees a PDF page); **BM25 relevance filter** (v0.47) strips off-topic blocks before synthesis
- **Knowledge graph:** typed graph JSON + reading tours + neighbors + shortest link path; export as `llms.txt` or **OKF bundle** (Google's Open Knowledge Format v0.1, with one of the ecosystem's first validators)
- **Click-to-open:** clickable links in chat via the bridge's `GET /open/<path>` route; `open_in_obsidian` does the same server-side (no browser — ideal for Claude Desktop)
- **Vault-creation wizard** (v0.35+): `plan_vault` → adjust → `provision_vault` , defaults-first (happy path = 1 interaction)
- **Multi-tenant mode** (v0.9+, opt-in): scope an instance by env vars — vault whitelist, read-only, per-user write audit — for MCPHub/proxy deployments
- **9 hooks** auto-wired at vault bootstrap: session auto-journal, hot-cache load/guard, wiki autocommit, link linter, doc-drift checker, update check...

## Vault setup

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1. Have Node.js ≥ 20.18.1 (+ Python 3.10+ on `PATH` for the conversion tools — postinstall creates a local `.venv` with `markitdown[all]` )
2. **Easiest path:** `/obsidian-router:meta-attach-vault` — interactive wizard that attaches a vault to a workspace (common case), bootstraps a standalone vault, or registers a remote one. Provisions plugins + scaffolds the wiki + binds `.env` + conventions picker.
3. CLI alternative:

```
npm run setup-vault -- "C:\VAULTS\MyVault"
```

⇒ installs/configures **Local REST API** + bridge plugins, writes `.env`, allocates a unique port, adds to the registry, wires the 9 hooks ( `--no-hooks` to opt out).

4. Optional for `search_smart` : **Smart Connections** + **obsidian-mcp-router-bridge** · for Templater: **Templater**

5. Verify: `/obsidian-router:meta-status` or just say "*diagnose the router*"

## Configuration — environment variables (workspace `.env`)

|                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
|--------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| VAULT_PATH                     | Path of the current vault. Auto-detection: if it matches a registered vault, that vault becomes the default. Written by <code>setup-vault.mjs</code> .                                                      |
| OBSIDIAN_ROUTER_DEFAULT_VAULT  | Explicit override of the default vault for this process. Wins over <code>VAULT_PATH</code> and over <code>config.defaultVault</code> . Also the workspace↔vault binding used by the wiki-query-first hooks. |
| OBSIDIAN_ROUTER_LOCKED         | Locks the router to one vault for the session. Any tool call to another vault throws. Set via <code>/obsidian-router:lock &lt;vault&gt; --persist</code> .                                                  |
| OBSIDIAN_ROUTER_AUTO_ENRICH    | Wiki auto-enrichment mode: <code>ClaudeAsk</code> (default)   <code>Hybrid</code>   <code>FullAuto</code>   <code>off</code> . Set via <code>/obsidian-router:auto-mode &lt;Mode&gt; --persist</code> .     |
| OBSIDIAN_ROUTER_ALLOWED_VAULTS | Multi-tenant (v0.9+): comma-separated whitelist of vaults this instance sees. Others are skipped.                                                                                                           |
| OBSIDIAN_ROUTER_READONLY       | Multi-tenant: <code>true</code> disables the 8 write tools (filtered from ListTools AND refused at call time).                                                                                              |
| OBSIDIAN_ROUTER_USER_ID        | Multi-tenant: audit trail — every successful write appends an attributed line to the vault's <code>wiki-meta/log.md</code> .                                                                                |
| VAULT_<NAME>                   | A whole vault defined in one env var (JSON: <code>name</code> , <code>baseUrl</code> , <code>apiKey</code> ...) — dashboard-editable on MCPHub deployments.                                                 |
| OBSIDIAN_ROUTER_NO_WATCH       | Disables hot-reload of the config file (useful for debugging).                                                                                                                                              |

## Important files — where things live

|                                                        |                                                                                                                                                     |
|--------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <code>~/.claude/obsidian-mcp-router/config.json</code> | Main router config (vaults, port registry, defaultVault, disabledVaults, remoteVaults). Hot-reload enabled.                                         |
| <code>~/.claude.json</code>                            | Claude Code/Desktop config. Must contain the <code>mcpServers.obsidian-router</code> entry pointing to the <code>obsidian-mcp-router</code> binary. |

|                                                                  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
|------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <code>~/.claude/settings.json</code>                             | The 9 hooks (auto-wired at vault bootstrap since v0.18.2). The plugin itself is enabled <b>per-workspace</b> via <code>&lt;workspace&gt;/ .claude/settings.json</code> — 45 commands + 42 skills ≈ 10k context tokens, only load them where you use Obsidian. |
| <code>&lt;workspace&gt;/ .env</code>                             | Environment variables for the current workspace (above). Auto-loaded at router boot.                                                                                                                                                                          |
| <code>&lt;vault&gt;/CLAUDE.md</code>                             | Vault wiki consigne — loaded by Claude Code into context. Includes the auto-enrichment consigne (4 modes) + installed conventions.                                                                                                                            |
| <code>&lt;vault&gt;/wiki-meta/{index,log,hot,overview}.md</code> | Karpathy LLM-wiki scaffolds (catalog, append-only journal, hot cache, overview) — under <code>wiki-meta/</code> since v0.12 (user pages live under <code>wiki/</code> ). Scaffolded by <code>/obsidian-router:wiki</code> .                                   |
| <code>&lt;vault&gt;/wiki-meta/Sessions/</code>                   | Per-session detail journals (auto-written by the <code>session-auto-journal</code> hook; <code>log.md</code> stays a thin index).                                                                                                                             |
| <code>obsidian-mcp-router/docs/</code>                           | <code>auto-enrichment.md</code> (4 modes + 4 placement channels), <code>features/</code> (13 prose feature pages), <code>architecture.md</code> , this PDF (EN + FR).                                                                                         |

# 45 slash commands /obsidian-router:<name> · auto-trigger on natural language

(EN + FR)

 16 MCP wrappers — one per core vault tool

Categories: discover · read · write · manage · template · convert

| COMMAND                 | EFFECT                                     | TRIGGER PHRASE (EN/FR)                               |
|-------------------------|--------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|
| discover-list-vaults    | List vaults (online/latency/lock state)    | "list my vaults" / "liste mes vaults"                |
| discover-list-files     | List files in a vault directory            | "list files in Sessions" / "liste les fichiers de X" |
| read-get                | Read a file (markdown + frontmatter)       | "show me X" / "montre-moi X"                         |
| read-search             | Plain-text (substring) search              | "grep for <text>" / "trouve <texte>"                 |
| read-search-smart       | Semantic search (Smart Connections)        | "find notes about X" / "trouve mes notes sur X"      |
| read-frontmatter        | Read frontmatter (object or one key)       | "metadata of X" / "quel est le statut de X"          |
| write-create-or-replace | PUT — create or replace a file             | "save this as X.md" / "crée une note X"              |
| write-append            | POST — append to a file                    | "append to my journal" / "ajoute à X"                |
| write-patch             | Surgical PATCH (heading/block/frontmatter) | "edit X section in Y" / "édite la section X dans Y"  |
| write-frontmatter-set   | Set one frontmatter key                    | "tag this with X" / "passe le statut de X à closed"  |
| write-frontmatter-merge | Set multiple keys in sequence              | "on X set status=closed outcome=tp1"                 |
| manage-move             | Move or rename a file                      | "move X to Y" / "renomme X en Y"                     |
| manage-delete           | Delete a file (2-step confirm guard)       | "delete X" then "yes confirm=true"                   |
| template-execute        | Execute a Templater template               | "run X template" / "rends Templates/X.md avec arg=v" |

|                         |                                                                  |                                                         |
|-------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|
| pdf-to-markdown         | Local PDF → markdown<br>(MarkItDown, fast plain-text)            | "convert this PDF to markdown" /<br>"convertis ce PDF"  |
| pdf-to-markdown-docling | High-fidelity PDF → markdown<br>(Docling, tables/layout, opt-in) | "convert with docling" /<br>"conversion haute fidélité" |

### 3 router-state commands (lock + auto-enrichment)

| COMMAND   | EFFECT                                                                     | TRIGGER PHRASE (EN/FR)                              |
|-----------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|
| lock      | Restrict the session to one vault<br>(volatile or <code>--persist</code> ) | "I only want to work on X" /<br>"verrouille sur X"  |
| unlock    | Lift the lock, restore multi-vault<br>routing                              | "unlock vaults" / "déverrouille les<br>vaults"      |
| auto-mode | Set the auto-enrichment mode<br>(ClaudeAsk / Hybrid / FullAuto /<br>off)   | "switch to Hybrid mode" / "passe<br>en mode Hybrid" |

### 6 conversational helpers (setup + diagnostic)

| COMMAND                     | EFFECT                                                                         | TRIGGER PHRASE (EN/FR)                                               |
|-----------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| meta-setup                  | Bootstrap the router on a fresh<br>machine                                     | "setup obsidian-mcp-router" /<br>"installe le router"                |
| meta-attach-vault           | Wizard — attach a vault to a<br>workspace (common), standalone,<br>or remote   | "attach a vault to this workspace" /<br>"connecte mon vault distant" |
| meta-status                 | Health-check every vault with fix<br>hints                                     | "are my vaults reachable" /<br>"diagnostique le router"              |
| meta-sync-template          | Propagate the reference vault's<br>plugins/snippets/docs to vaults<br>(picker) | "sync the template to all vaults" /<br>"synchronise le template"     |
| meta-audit-bridge-readiness | Audit click-to-open readiness<br>(bridge, REST API, HTTP, live<br>/open probe) | "is click-to-open ready" / "audite le<br>bridge"                     |
| conventions                 | Install/remove/status/propagate<br>CLAUDE.md conventions cross-<br>vaults      | "install source-type on X" / "installe<br>la convention X"           |

## 20 knowledge-management commands (Karpathy-style LLM-wiki)

| COMMAND        | EFFECT                                                                         | TRIGGER PHRASE (EN/FR)                                    |
|----------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| wiki           | Scaffold the wiki in a vault (index, log, hot, overview)                       | "set up a wiki" / "scaffold un wiki"                      |
| wiki-ingest    | Ingest a source → entity/concept pages + cross-refs                            | "absorb this article" / "ingère cette URL"                |
| wiki-query     | 3-tier RAG over the wiki (no web)                                              | "what does my wiki say about X" / "d'après mes notes ..." |
| wiki-lint      | Health check (orphans, dead links, index drift)                                | "audit my wiki" / "lint le wiki"                          |
| wiki-fold      | Idempotent log rollup under wiki/folds/                                        | "fold the log" / "compacte le journal"                    |
| hot-compact    | Compact an oversized hot.md back to its cache contract (verified backup first) | "compact the hot cache" / "compacte le hot"               |
| save           | File the conversation as a typed wiki note (session/decision/ADR/...)          | "save this" / "sauvegarde ça"                             |
| autoresearch   | Autonomous web→synth→file loop                                                 | "research X online" / "fais une recherche web sur X"      |
| canvas         | Create/edit Obsidian .canvas files                                             | "create a canvas for X" / "crée un canvas pour X"         |
| defuddle       | Strip noise from web pages before ingestion                                    | "defuddle <url>" / "nettoie cette page"                   |
| obsidian-bases | Create/edit Obsidian .base files (database views)                              | "create a base for X" / "crée une base pour X"            |
| wiki-graph     | Build the typed knowledge-graph JSON (feeds the native graph viewer)           | "build the wiki graph" / "construis le graphe"            |
| wiki-tour      | Ordered pedagogical reading tour from the link topology                        | "give me a tour of this vault" / "par où je commence"     |
| wiki-neighbors | One page's neighbors — links out, backlinks, or both                           | "what links to X" / "voisins de X"                        |

|                      |                                                                                |                                                                |
|----------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|
| wiki-path            | Shortest link chain between two pages                                          | "how is X connected to Y" / "quel rapport entre X et Y"        |
| wiki-export          | Export the vault as llms.txt / llms-full.txt or an OKF bundle                  | "export the wiki as llms.txt" / "exporte le wiki"              |
| okf-export           | Export a wiki subset as a shareable OKF v0.1 bundle (conformance self-checked) | "export this folder as an OKF bundle" / "publie en bundle OKF" |
| okf-check            | Validate any OKF bundle against the v0.1 conformance rules                     | "validate this OKF bundle" / "ce bundle est-il conforme ?"     |
| wiki-refresh-digests | Regenerate per-page digest sidecars (concepts/claims/keywords)                 | "refresh the digests" / "rafraîchis les digests"               |
| who-is-speaking      | Identify the family member in a shared vault, lock routing per member          | "who is speaking" / "c'est Karine"                             |

## The 42 MCP tools — what Claude actually calls under the hood

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|                                                                                                                       |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <code>list_vaults · list_files</code>                                                                                 | <b>Discovery.</b> Vault catalog with online status + latency (call first); directory listing.                                                                                                                                             |
| <code>get_file · search · search_smart · get_frontmatter</code>                                                       | <b>Reads.</b> Full file; substring search; semantic search (Smart Connections embeddings, cosine scores); typed frontmatter. <code>vault: "*" = cross-vault fan-out.</code>                                                               |
| <code>write_file · append_to_file · patch_file · delete_file · set_frontmatter · merge_frontmatter · move_file</code> | <b>Writes &amp; file management.</b> Create/replace; append; surgical patch by heading/block/frontmatter; guarded delete ( <code>confirm: true</code> ); one or many frontmatter keys; move/rename.                                       |
| <code>execute_template</code>                                                                                         | <b>Templater.</b> Render a template, optionally write the result; args via <code>tp.mcpTools.prompt("key")</code> .                                                                                                                       |
| <code>lock_vault · unlock_vaults · set_auto_enrich_mode</code>                                                        | <b>Router state.</b> Single-vault isolation; auto-enrichment mode switch.                                                                                                                                                                 |
| <code>plan_vault · provision_vault</code>                                                                             | <b>Vault provisioning</b> (v0.35+). Read-only plan (defaults + questionnaire + warnings) → one-call creation (plugins, port, API key, wiki scaffold, registry). Local-only.                                                               |
| <code>pdf/docx/xlsx/pptx/image/audio_to_markdown</code>                                                               | <b>Local conversion</b> (Markdown). Office/PDF/image OCR/audio transcription → markdown text; chain with <code>write_file</code> .                                                                                                        |
| <code>pdf_to_markdown_docling · pdf_to_images</code>                                                                  | <b>High-fidelity PDF</b> (opt-in Docling): layout + table-structure recognition. <code>pdf_to_images</code> renders pages to PNG so the model can see them (capped pages/bytes).                                                          |
| <code>youtube/bing_search/webpage_to_markdown · git_repo_to_markdown</code>                                           | <b>Remote conversion.</b> URL → markdown (SSRF-guarded); YouTube transcripts; git repo → single markdown bundle (repomix, optional Tree-sitter compression). <code>webpage_to_markdown</code> accepts <code>relevanceQuery</code> (BM25). |
| <code>filter_relevant_blocks</code>                                                                                   | <b>Relevance filter</b> (v0.47). Deterministic BM25 second pass over markdown you already have — drops off-topic blocks, keeps frontmatter/headings, multiple no-op safety nets. No fetch, no LLM.                                        |
| <code>extract_page_metadata · propose_linked_sources · download_page_assets</code>                                    | <b>Web ingestion support.</b> Deterministic page metadata (JSON-LD/OpenGraph); scored link-following candidates; image download into the vault.                                                                                           |

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`get_wiki_context_pack` · `build_wiki_graph` ·  
`build_wiki_tour` · `get_page_neighbors` ·  
`wiki_path`

**Context & graph.** Structured context envelope for external agents; typed knowledge graph; reading tours; per-page neighbors; shortest link path.

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`build_open_link` · `open_in_obsidian`

**Navigation.** Ready-to-paste click-to-open links; server-side open (raise Obsidian window, optional heading anchor) — no browser round-trip.

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**Tips** · Type `/obsidian-router:` in Claude Code → autocomplete · Every command accepts a `vault` argument (wrappers fall back to the default) · `vault: "*" on search / search_smart` = cross-vault fan-out · Trigger phrases are indicative — Claude recognizes variants · Write results carry a ready-made `clickToOpenUrl` — one click opens the note in Obsidian · Full docs: `README.md` , `docs/features/` (13 pages), `docs/auto-enrichment.md` in the repo.